

Immunization Reactions - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1198 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Post-vaccination reaction assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published vaccine side-effect and anaphylaxis guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] Which vaccine, and when was it given?
2. [TEMPERATURE] Has a temperature been measured?
3. [OPEN_TEXT] Describe the reaction, onset, breathing, alertness, rash, fever, hydration, neurologic symptoms, and injection-site changes.
4. [OPEN_TEXT] Record age, pregnancy, immune suppression, allergy history, vaccine and batch if available, medicines, and whether symptoms could be unrelated acute illness.

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Anaphylaxis

Are throat or tongue swelling, breathing difficulty, faintness, confusion, or collapse occurring after vaccination?

Systemic allergic-reaction features require the Anaphylaxis pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there facial, mouth, throat or tongue swelling, breathing difficulty, wheeze, collapse, reduced responsiveness, blue/grey colour, seizure, severe confusion, non-blanching rash with illness, or other rapidly progressive reaction?

NHS.UK vaccine guidance: serious allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) to a vaccine is very rare but requires an immediate 999 call and adrenaline auto-injector if available.

1. Disposition level 15

Is there pain or soreness at the injection site, a slightly raised temperature, or an aching body, with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance: the most common vaccine side effects are mild and get better within 1-2 days.

Advice

Emergency post-vaccination precautions

- Call Qatar 999 now. Use the patient's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately for suspected anaphylaxis and follow its plan; do not delay the call. Position according to breathing and consciousness, do not allow standing or driving, and follow call-handler instructions. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: breathing, swelling, collapse, seizure, or consciousness worsens.

Low-risk expected vaccine reaction care

- Rest, take normal fluids, and use a wrapped cool compress at the injection site. A pharmacist or clinician must confirm fever or pain medicine for age, weight, pregnancy, medical history, and doses already taken. Do not assume persistent or worsening illness is vaccine-related.
- Call Back If: breathing or swelling changes, seizure, severe illness, dehydration, persistent fever, or worsening injection-site redness.

First aid

- Call Qatar 999 now. Use the patient's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately for suspected anaphylaxis and follow its plan; do not delay the call. Position according to breathing and consciousness, do not allow standing or driving, and follow call-handler instructions. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Flu vaccine" (side effects section), <https://www.nhs.uk/vaccinations/flu-vaccine/> (page last reviewed 23 November 2023)

Provenance

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